

Ernest SONG

Chief Growth & Transformation Officer

📍 B-1000 Brussels, Belgium ✉ contact@ernestsong.com ☎ 0476 60 05 90 🌐 ernestsong.com

Profile

Finance leader with 15+ years leading accounting and transformation mandates for multi-entity, multi-country organisations across BE, FR and NL. I specialise in General Accounting (GL, AP, AR) and financial-close leadership, and in guiding ERP replacements from AS-IS diagnosis to SAP S/4HANA go-live. What sets me apart is perspective: I've sat on both the operator's and the executive-recruiter's side of the table, so I read the numbers and the organisation behind them. I bring calm under pressure, rigorous Power BI / Cognos reporting, and a genuine commitment to turning finance into a lever for growth.

Experience

Engie SEM, Strategic Business Analyst & Finance Automation Lead (Freelancer)

Brussels, BE

Jan 2026 – present
9 months

- Led the financial controlling pilot phase for the SAP S/4HANA migration across French subsidiaries, successfully acting as the core Business Analyst bridging IT architecture and strategic business operations.
- Designed, built, and deployed a robust, automated budget modeling tool from scratch within a critical 2-week timeline, ensuring operational continuity during a resource gap and replacing an unreliable legacy framework.
- Streamlined and automated financial closing processes for commodity trading activities, deploying advanced PowerQuery ETL workflows to safely ingest batches of 1,500+ bookings per close with zero human intervention.
- Reconciled complex financial data structures between middle-office databases (IVDB) and SAP S/4HANA while restructuring and simplifying the Work Breakdown Structure (WWS) project codes to optimize portfolio monitoring.

Holcim, Senior Operational Excellence & Data Lead (Freelancer)

Nivelles, BE

Jan 2024 – Dec 2025
2 years

- Leveraged data insights derived from market analysis to restructure production workflows post-M&A, significantly enhancing efficiency.
- Managed SAP HANA migration, restructuring data and ensuring system integrity.
- Developed rebate models (matrix & automated SAP), aligning with commercial strategy.
- Implemented QlikSense with new data for financial reporting and insights.
- Ensured data reliability and liaised with auditors on rebate matters.

Engie Tractebel, Cash Flow & Financial Modeling Specialist (Freelancer)

Brussels, BE

Mar 2023 – Dec 2023
10 months

- Design cashflow reporting and cash exposure per project.
- Assessment of financing needs in local entity, credit analysis of specific counterpart and impairment testing.
- Develop Finance data modelling from SAP for HANA and design Power BI reporting.

Shurgard, Investment & Corporate Development Analyst (Freelancer)

Brussels, BE

Feb 2022 – Feb 2023
1 year 1 month

- Analyzed and managed real estate projects, including construction, redevelopment, and acquisition of self-storage businesses.
- Maintained project dashboard and initiated corporate development projects to improve department policies and procedures.
- Designed the data model and visualization for the Investment department's Business Intelligence efforts.
- Collaborated in the development of a new pricing model using Artificial Intelligence.

Magnetrap, Freelance CFO / Fundraising Consultant

- Acted as interim CFO and led fundraising, organizing €3M in debt/equity fund raises.
- Created cash flow projections, business plans, and long-term financial goals.
- Monitored company performance and implemented corrective actions as needed.
- Prepared operating results reports and managed financial models for long-term use.

Mons, BE
Nov 2020 – Jan 2022
1 year 3 months

Tobania, Director Business Process Automation

- Led development and implementation of citizen developer business model using RPA and self-service BI, including pricing strategy and roadmap.
- Managed business development, including marketing strategy, pre-sales, and sales, and identified new business opportunities.
- Implemented process optimization, standardization, and harmonization to improve efficiency and profitability for customers.
- Provided regular, tailored reports to help customers monitor and control costs and make data-driven business decisions, and established change management structures and strategies to facilitate successful adoption of new processes and technologies.

Brussels, BE
Feb 2020 – Oct 2020
9 months

Soap collect, Founder

- Established a non-profit organization focused on providing hygiene products to disadvantaged communities.
- Formed partnerships with luxury hotel chains to source used soap for reconditioning.

Phnom Penh, KH
Jan 2019 – present
7 years 9 months

Degroof Petercam, Performance Management Project Leader

- Finance Transformation Operating Model (FTOM)
- Designed and implemented a client-centric performance management system.
- Optimized finance close process for improved governance, internal control, and data quality.
- Led projects related to regulatory reporting sourcing and followed BPM standards.
- Conducted gap analysis of business requirements and existing procedures to identify areas for improvement.

Brussels, BE
Jan 2018 – Dec 2018
1 year

Vinci Airports, Managing Director & Head of Project Financial Modeling / Cursus Grand Talent

- Value creation: valuation at 4 times of acquisition cost.
- Led deployment of airport operations at 50+ locations in various countries.
- Developed long-term financial business model including analysis of macroeconomic impact, capital expenditures, and concession valuation.
- Negotiated extension of concession contract with Portuguese authorities and implemented new financial business model to improve budgeting and forecasting processes.
- Managed accounting and financial reporting in accordance with BE-GAAP standards.

Brussels, BE & Lisbon, PT
Feb 2016 – Dec 2017
1 year 11 months

Rexel, Freelance Finance Consolidation & Reporting Consultant

- Led the implementation of IFRS financial reporting for Asia-Pacific, Latin America, and Canadian subsidiaries.
- Spearheaded the restructuring process and integration of SAP BPC and Cognos reporting systems.
- Performed annual budgeting, monthly forecasting, and analyses of actual vs. budgeted/estimated results.
- Led the strategic planning process for the organization.

Paris, FR
Sept 2014 – Jan 2016
1 year 5 months

KPMG Audit, Financial Auditor Supervisor

Paris, FR

- Conducted audits of financial statements using various accounting standards, including testing of key processes in accordance with SOX requirements.
- Experienced in auditing financial modeling for long-term contracts, particularly in the context of Public-Private Partnerships (PPP).
- Certified FP7 Grant Agreements for the EU Research program and led audit teams and supervised financial auditors.
- Developed partnerships and identified new markets to support business growth.
- Main sector: Construction (Vinci, Eiffage, Colas), Real estate (Nexity), Water distribution (Veolia), International parcels distribution (Geopost from La Poste group), Security (Brink's), Healthcare (DomusVie).

Jan 2011 – Aug 2014
3 years 8 months**ICM - Brain & Spine Institute**, Deputy CFO Trainee

Paris, FR

- Implemented the budget system and prepared business plans for the scientific teams.
- Established the internal control system for purchasing and donation processes and managed bank reconciliation.
- Prepared the institutional audit necessary for the certification by the 'Comité de la Charte'.

Nov 2009 – Aug 2010
10 months

Education

Specialized Master's degree - **ESCP Business School**, #1 FT 2026Paris, FR
2011

Auditing and Consulting

Ranked #1 full-time Master in 2026 (FT Rankings)

Specialized Master's degree**Master's degree** - **Université Paris Nanterre**, Management Science and Financial ControlParis, FR
2010

Management Science and Financial Control

Master's degree

Competencies

Business

- MS Office (advanced Excel, Power Query)

ERP

- SAP HANA

Business Intelligence

- MS Power BI
- QlikSense
- Business Object
- Cognos
- Hyperion

RPA

- UiPath
- MS PowerAutomate

Agile

- Jira
- Confluence

Data & Analytics

- VBA
- SQL
- R

Languages

Native:

- French
- Khmer
- Teochew

Proficient:

- English

Basics:

- Dutch (A2)
- Spanish
- Mandarin

Interests

Sustainable development

Powerlifting

Mountain biking

Tennis

Interpersonal

Fast-learner

Problem solver

Diplomacy

Driven

Autonomous

Teampayer